‘This is part of a larger and more subtle American attempt to sow seeds of suspicion between us and our smaller neighbours. Moynihan referred to Nepal being apprehensive of India’s dominant role in the region. My own assessment is that it is not our smaller neighbours conveying their so-called anxieties to the Americans, but rather the US government trying to create misunderstandings between us. The USA is misinterpreting our relations with the Soviet Union to our neighbours with a view to create distrust against us, while the US itself is taking various steps to strengthen understanding and cooperation with the Soviet Union.’

This was an interesting analysis by the then foreign secretary, who had decided not to buy everything the Americans were selling. R&AW officers who have spent considerable time in the USA and the Soviet Union said that the US propaganda machinery was strong and they used various agencies including social institutions to mislead targeted countries.

Preacher Spy of the CIA

In December 1975, the Indian government was alarmed by a startling claim made by US Senator Mark Hatfield. He had accused the CIA of using missionaries to spy on other nations. In a statement in the Senate, Hatfield had said:

Mr. President, this summer, various news sources reported that the Central Intelligence Agency has made it a regular practice over the years to use missionaries, clergy and members of religious organizations for intelligence activities. It is my firm belief that this practice tarnishes the image of the United States in foreign countries, prostitutes the church and violates the first amendment’s separation of Church and state.